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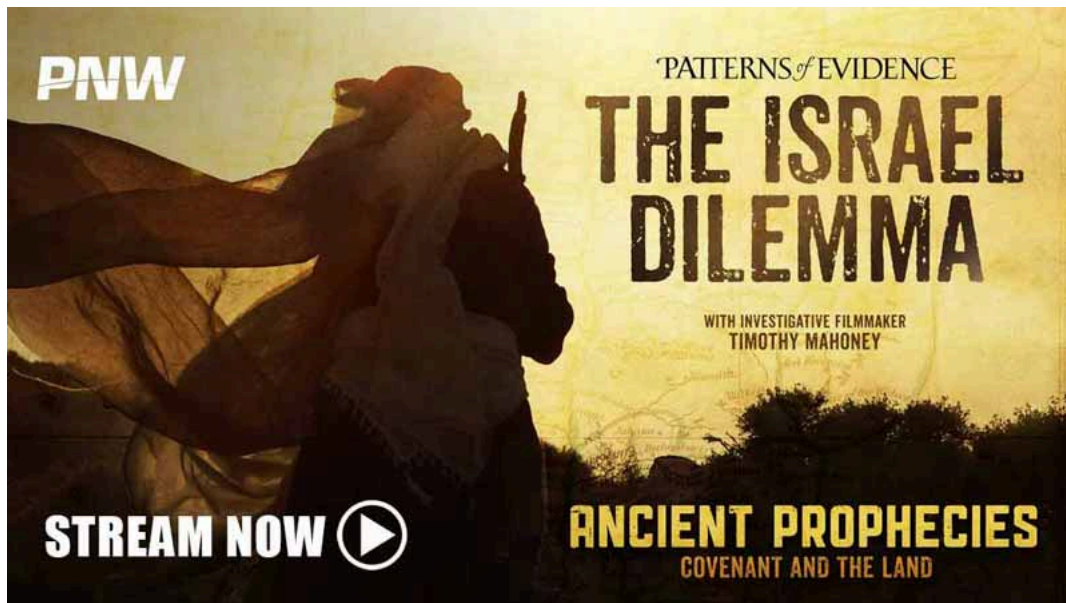
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ARTICLE

Turkey Now Has Israel In Its Crosshairs: New Missile Can Reach Tel Aviv



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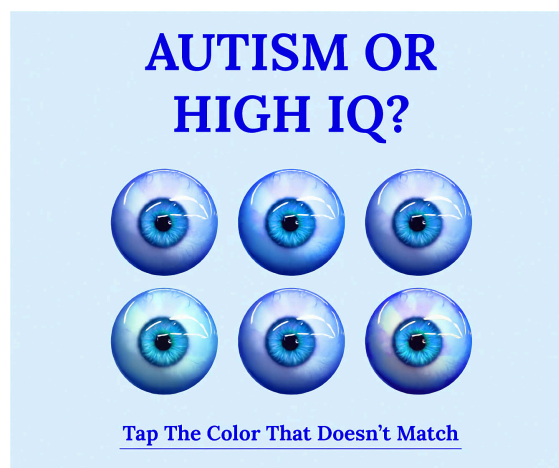
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For decades, modern Turkey was viewed by Israel and the West as one of the few stable Muslim-majority nations that could bridge East and West. It was a NATO ally, a strategic military partner, and at times even a quiet friend to Jerusalem. But today, under the leadership of Recep Tayyip Erdoğan, Turkey has transformed into something far more dangerous — an increasingly militant regional power openly hostile toward Israel and deeply driven by neo-Ottoman ambitions.

What once seemed unthinkable is now openly discussed in Turkish political and religious circles: the idea of leading the Islamic world against Jerusalem.

That is no longer rhetoric confined to obscure extremists. Erdoğan himself has repeatedly escalated anti-Israel language, accusing Israel of genocide, comparing Israeli leaders to dictators, and positioning Turkey as the defender of the Muslim world against the Jewish state. At the same time, Ankara has deepened ties with Islamist movements, provided shelter to Hamas leadership, and supported factions in Syria tied to radical Islamist ideologies.

Now a new development is raising alarms far beyond the Middle East.



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The implications are enormous.

For years, Israel's greatest conventional threats were believed to come from Iran and its proxy network — Hezbollah in Lebanon, Hamas in Gaza, and militias scattered throughout Syria and Iraq. That has all changed dramatically in the past few months and while Iran still has some capabilities, it is nothing like it once was. But Turkey represents a very different kind of challenge. Unlike Iran, Turkey is a NATO member with one of the largest militaries in the world, a massive industrial base, growing defense manufacturing capabilities, and increasing influence across the Sunni Muslim world.

Iran operates through proxies and shadow warfare. Turkey increasingly projects organized state power.

This is what makes the current moment so historically significant. Turkey is no longer merely criticizing Israel diplomatically. It is building the military, ideological, and geopolitical framework necessary to become a direct regional challenger to Jerusalem itself.



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The shift has happened gradually enough that much of the West still struggles to recognize it. Erdoğan has spent years cultivating what many analysts describe as a neo-Ottoman vision — reviving Turkish influence across lands once ruled by the Ottoman Empire. That includes Syria, Iraq, Libya, the eastern Mediterranean, and critically, Jerusalem.

The Ottoman Empire controlled Jerusalem for nearly 400 years before its collapse after World War I. For some within Turkey's Islamist political movement, that loss still carries deep historical and spiritual significance. Erdoğan has repeatedly invoked Ottoman imagery and legacy in speeches, portraying Turkey not merely as a nation-state, but as the rightful guardian of Islamic civilization.

This is where geopolitics begins intersecting with Bible prophecy in ways many Christians are increasingly watching closely.

The Bible repeatedly warns that Jerusalem would become the focal point of international conflict in the last days. The prophet Book of Zechariah declared that Jerusalem would become "a burdensome stone for all people," while nations would gather against it. The prophet

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No one can claim with certainty exactly how future prophetic events will unfold. History has humbled many who tried to force current events too neatly into biblical timelines. Yet it is impossible to ignore the broader trajectory unfolding before the world's eyes.

Turkey is moving away from secular nationalism and toward religious nationalism. Away from cooperation with Israel and toward confrontation. Away from Western moderation and toward Islamist populism.

And unlike many of Israel's enemies, Turkey possesses the infrastructure, economy, military sophistication, and geographic position to become a truly transformational regional force.

That reality should concern not only Christians watching prophecy, but policymakers watching geopolitics.

Because history repeatedly shows that civilizations often fail to recognize major threats until they fully emerge. The world once assumed Russia would permanently integrate into the Western order after the Cold War. It assumed China's economic rise would liberalize its politics. It assumed the Middle East was becoming less ideological and more pragmatic.

Now another assumption may be collapsing: that Turkey would remain permanently anchored to the West.

Instead, the nation that once stood as a bridge between civilizations increasingly appears to be choosing a side.

And Jerusalem remains at the center of it all.

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